This document is an authorized copy for the course Master in Management 2027 - Organizational Behavior - B taught by prof. Villamor, Isabel at IESE B.S.

DPO-472-E
December 2019

Bob Knowlton (III)

Maximilian B. Torres

Knowlton found an opportunity to speak to Jerrold and raised the question. He remarked that, with the meetings coming up and with the contributions that Fester had been making, he would probably like to come to these meetings, but there was a question of the feelings of the others in the group if Fester alone were invited. Jerrold passed this over very lightly by saying that he didn't think the group would fail to understand Fester's rather different position and that he thought that Fester should be invited by all means. Knowlton immediately replied that he had thought so too and that he felt Fester should present the work because much of it was his own; and that, as Knowlton put it, this would be a nice way to acknowledge Fester's contributions and to reward him since he was eager to be recognized as a productive member of the lab. Jerrold agreed; the matter was decided.

Fester's presentation was very successful and in some ways dominated the meeting. He attracted the interest and attention of many of those who had come, and a long discussion followed his presentation. Later in the evening, with the entire laboratory staff present, during the cocktail party before dinner, a little circle of people formed about Fester. One of them was Jerrold himself, and a lively discussion ensued concerning the application of Fester's theory. All of this disturbed Knowlton and his reaction and behavior were characteristic. He joined the circle, praised Fester to Jerrold and to others, and remarked on the brilliance of the work.

While Knowlton was pondering the possibility of finding a similar job elsewhere, he received an offer to become project head in a large new laboratory that was starting up in a nearby locale. Conditions were nearly identical to those of his present job, though the salary was slightly higher

---

This is a revised version of the case adapted by Professor Maximilian B. Torres from the original "Bob Knowlton" case (HBS–Boston, Mass.: Harvard Business School Publishing, by Professors Alex Bavelas, A.H. Rubintein and H.A. Shepard). December 2019.
Cases are designed to promote class discussion rather than to illustrate effective or ineffective management of a given situation.
This revision is for exclusive use at IESE.

Copyright © 2019, IESE. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, used in a spreadsheet, or transmitted in any form or by any means - electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording, or otherwise - without the permission of IESE.

Document only to be used in IESE programs.

Last edited: 12/18/19